

2024 年 6 月大学英语六级真题（第二套）

Part I

Writing

(30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to write an essay that begins with the sentence *"There is a growing awareness of the importance of digital literacy and skills in today's world."* You can make comments, cite examples or use your personal experiences to develop your essay. You should write at least 150 words but no more than 200 words. (You should copy the sentence given in quotes at the beginning of your essay.)

【范文】

"There is a growing awareness of the importance of digital literacy and skills in today's world."

In our increasingly digitalized society, proficiency in digital literacy has become indispensable. Digital literacy encompasses the ability to navigate, evaluate, and utilize information effectively in various digital platforms and technologies. This skill set is not only crucial for personal development but also for professional success in virtually every field.

Firstly, digital literacy empowers individuals to access and critically evaluate information from a wide range of sources. With the abundance of information available online, the ability to discern reliable sources and separate fact from misinformation is vital. This skill is particularly relevant in academic research, where accurate information retrieval is essential.

Secondly, in the workplace, digital literacy is a fundamental requirement across diverse industries. From basic computer proficiency to advanced data analysis and programming skills, employers increasingly seek candidates who are adept at using digital tools to enhance productivity and innovation.

Moreover, digital literacy fosters creativity and collaboration. Platforms such as social media, digital content creation tools, and virtual collaboration software enable individuals to express ideas, collaborate globally, and engage in continuous learning and professional development.

In conclusion, embracing digital literacy equips individuals with the skills necessary to thrive in the digital age. As technology continues to evolve, maintaining and expanding one's digital literacy skills will be essential for personal growth, career advancement, and active participation in our interconnected world.

【范文译文】

“在今天日益数字化的社会中，对数字素养和技能重要性的认识正在增强。”

在我们日益数字化的社会中，数字素养已经成为不可或缺的能力。数字素养包括有效地在各种数字平台和技术中导航、评估和利用信息的能力。这种技能不仅对个人发展至关重要，也对几乎每个领域的职业成功至关重要。

首先，数字素养使个人能够从各种信息来源中获取并批判性评估信息。随着在线信息的丰富，能够辨别可靠来源、区分事实和错误信息的能力至关重要。这种能力在学术研究中尤为重要，因为准确的信息检索是必不可少的。

其次，在工作场所，数字素养是各个行业的基本要求。从基本的计算机操作到高级的数据分析和编程技能，雇主越来越多地寻求那些能够熟练使用数字工具来提升生产力和创新能力的候选人。

此外，数字素养促进了创造力和协作。诸如社交媒体、数字内容创建工具和虚拟协作软件等平台使个人能够表达想法、在全球范围内进行协作，并参与持续学习和职业发展。

总之，拥抱数字素养赋予个人在数字时代蓬勃发展所需的能力。随着技术的不断演进，保持和扩展自己的数字素养技能对个人成长、职业发展以及在我们日益互联的世界中积极参与至关重要。

Part II

Listening Comprehension

(30 minutes)

[Key]

1. B) Sign the agreement if one small change is made to it.
2. A) They are becoming impatient.
3. C) To avoid any conflict of interest.
4. C) It is a negligible market for his company.
5. A) They are thrilled by a rare astronomic phenomenon.
6. B) It will come closest to Earth in more than one hundred years.
7. A) A blur.
8. D) Make use of phone apps.

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9. A) Whether consumers should be warned against ultra-processed foods.
10. B) By the degree of industrial processing.
11. B) Greater risk of chronic diseases.
12. D) They begin to see the world in a different way.
13. C) It is a creative person's response to limitation.
14. C) People have no incentive to use available resources in new ways.
15. D) It thrives best when constrained.
16. A) Because they are learned.
17. C) The importance of one's goals and of the relationship.
18. B) The owl.
19. A) Help save species from extinction and boost human health.
20. B) It has entered the sixth mass extinction.
21. D) It is the most exciting, most relevant, most timely and most internationally inspirational.
22. D) Human individuality.
23. A) It is a delusion to be disposed of.
24. D) He contends most of our body cells can only live a few days or weeks.
25. C) By becoming aware that we are part of a bigger world.

Section A

Directions: In this section, you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear four questions. Both the conversation and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 1 to 4 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

Listen

主题：商讨合同细节

W: Thank you for meeting with me, Steven, at such short notice.

M: Not a problem, Margaret. Now, please give me some good news. Have you agreed to my last proposal?

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W: I have, indeed. 1) And I wish to sign the agreement, pending one small change to be made to the contract.

W: Margaret, we have been through this for almost a year now, back and forth, making alterations. Are you sure you want to make a sponsorship deal for your clients or not? 2) I ask this because, frankly, some people at my end are running out of patience.

W: I understand your concerns. But as I'm sure you understand, we hold our client's best interest to be of the utmost concern. We therefore comb through the fine details of all contracts. Rest assured we all appreciate your firm's patience.

M: Okay. Fine. So what changes do you wish to make?

W: Essentially, we would like the new deal to exclude the Middle East. That's all.

M: The middle east? Why?

W: My client has a couple of other perspective marketing deals from companies in the Middle East. Those offers should they materialize would exclusively employ my clients image in the Middle East only. 3) Therefore, in order to avoid any conflict, we would need to ensure that both marketing campaigns do not overlap geographically.

M: What business sector in the Middle East are we talking about here?

W: Real estate.

M: Well, that should be okay then. 3) So long as the product is very different from our food and beverage market, there should be no conflict of interest. Nevertheless, I will have to run this through my people. I don't foresee any problem, though. 4) The Middle East is a negligible market for us, but I still need to check this with a couple of departments.

Questions 1 to 4 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

1. What does the woman say she will do?

B) Sign the agreement if one small change is made to it.

2. What does the man say about some people he represents?

A) They are becoming impatient.

3. What reason does the woman give for the new deal to exclude the Middle East?

C) To avoid any conflict of interest.

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4. What does the man say about the Middle East?

C) It is a negligible market for his company.

Questions 5 to 8 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

Listen

主题：观测彗星

M: Next, we have a special science related news story. Paula Hancock is at the Denver Observatory. Paula, what is the big story over there?

W: Hi, John. 5) Yes, all the astronomers on site here are very excited. In fact, space enthusiasts all across North America and the rest of the northern hemisphere will be congregated on mountain tops tonight to watch the night sky.

M: Why? What's the big event? Is there an eclipse happening soon?

W: 5) Tonight, the Earth will come into close proximity with the Oppenheimer comet. 6) It is the closest our planet has been to such a phenomenon in over 100 years. For this reason, it is expected that thousands of people will gaze up at the sky tonight in order to see this formidable object.

M: How far away is this comet? Will people be able to see it with the naked eye?

W: The Oppenheimer comet will still be millions of miles away on the edge of our galaxy. But nevertheless, this is a relatively close distance, close enough for people to observe in good detail through a telescope. 7) People will only see a blur without one. However, that does not mean one needs professional equipment. Even the most ordinary of telescopes should be conducive for people to observe and wonder at this flying object.

M: Many of our viewers will be wondering how they too can take part in this once in a lifetime event. Where will this comet be in the sky? How can people find it?

W: The comet will be almost exactly due north at 60 degrees above the equator. 8) However, finding the comet is indeed very tricky and scientists here have told me there are plenty of phone apps that will facilitate this.

M: How fantastic! Thank you Paula for the information.

Questions 5 to 8 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

5. What does the woman say about all the astronomers at the *Denver Observatory*?

A) They are thrilled by a rare astronomic phenomenon.

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6. What do we learn from the conversation about the Oppenheimer comet?

B) It will come closest to Earth in more than one hundred years.

7. What does the woman say people will only see in the sky without a telescope?

A) A blur.

8. What do scientists at the *Denver Observatory* advise amateurs do to facilitate their observation?

D) Make use of phone apps.

Section B

Directions: In this section, you will hear two passages. At the end of each passage, you will hear three or four questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 9 to 11 are based on the passage you have just heard.

Listen



主题：过度加工食品

Source: ScienceDaily

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Title: Are ultra-processed foods harmful? Experts weigh the evidence

Dietary guidelines form the basis for nutrition advice and regulations around the world. 9) While there is strong scientific consensus around most existing guidelines, one question has recently stirred debate: Should consumers be warned to avoid ultra-processed foods?

Two papers published today in *The American Journal of Clinical Nutrition* outline the case for and against using the concept of ultra-processed foods to help inform dietary guidelines beyond conventional food classification systems. The authors, Carlos A. Monteiro of the University of São Paulo, and Arne Astrup of Novo Nordisk Foundation, will discuss the issue in a live virtual debate, August 14th, during NUTRITION 2024 LIVE ONLINE.

10) The debate centers around a system developed by Monteiro and colleagues that classifies foods by their degree of industrial processing, ranging from unprocessed to ultra-processed. The system defines ultra-processed foods as those made using sequences of processes that extract substances from foods and alter them with

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chemicals in order to formulate the final product. Ultra-processed foods are characteristically designed to be cheap, tasty and convenient. Examples include soft drinks and candy, packaged snacks and pastries, ready-to-heat products, and reconstituted meat products.

11) Studies have linked consumption of ultra-processed foods — which are often high in salt, sugar and fat — with weight gain, and an increased risk of chronic diseases, even after adjusting for the amount of salt, sugar and fat in the diet. While the mechanisms behind these associations are not fully understood, Monteiro argues that the existing evidence is sufficient to justify discouraging consumption of ultra-processed foods in dietary recommendations and government policies.

Questions 9 to 11 are based on the passage you have just heard.

9. What question is said to have recently stirred debate?

A) Whether consumers should be warned against ultra-processed foods.

10. How does the system developed by Monteiro and colleagues classify foods?

B) By the degree of industrial processing.

11. What is consumption of ultra-processed foods linked with according to studies?

B) Greater risk of chronic diseases.

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Questions 12 to 15 are based on the passage you have just heard.

Listen

主题：约束和限制如何提高我们的创造力？

Source: mpetersonmusic.com

Title: How do restrictions and limitations INCREASE our creativity?

Believe it, or not, human creativity benefits from constraints. 12) According to psychologists, when you have less to work with, you actually begin to see the world differently. With constraints, you dedicate your mental energy to acting more resourcefully. When challenged, you figure out new ways to be better. The most successful creative people know that constraints give their minds the impetus to leap higher. People who invent new products are not limited by what they don't have or can't do. They leverage their limitations to push themselves even further.

Many products and services are created because the founders saw a limitation in what they use. They

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created innovation based on what was not working for them at the moment. 13) Innovation is a creative person's response to limitation. In a 2015 study, which examined how thinking about scarcity or abundance influences how creatively people use their resources. 14) Ravi Mehta at the University of Illinois and Meng Zhu at Johns Hopkins University found that people simply have no incentive to use what's available to them in novel ways.

When people face scarcity, they give themselves the freedom to use resources in less conventional ways because they have to. Obstacles can broaden your perception and open up your thinking processes. Consistent constraints help you improve at connecting unrelated ideas and concepts.

Marissa Mayer, former vice-president for search products and user experience at Google once wrote in a publication on Bloomberg, "Constraints shape and focus problems and provide clear challenges to overcome. 15) Creativity thrives best when constrained."

Questions 12 to 15 are based on the passage you have just heard.

12. What do psychologists say people do when they are short of resources?

D) They begin to see the world in a different way.



13. What does the passage say about innovation?

C) It is a creative person's response to limitation.

14. What did a 2015 study by Ravi Mehta and Meng Zhu find?

C) People have no incentive to use available resources in new ways.

15. What did Marissa Mayer once write concerning creativity?

D) It thrives best when constrained.

Section C

Directions: In this section, you will hear three recordings of lectures or talks followed by three or four questions.

The recordings will be played only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 1** with a single line through the centre.

Questions 16 to 18 are based on the recording you have just heard.

Listen

主题：如何处理冲突？

Source: Sarah Nilsson

Title: How do you manage conflict?

Different people use different strategies for managing conflicts. These strategies are learned in childhood. Usually we are not aware of how we act in conflict situations. We just do whatever seems to come naturally. 16) But we do have a personal strategy, and because it is learned, we can always change it by learning new and more effective ways of managing conflicts.

When you get involved in a conflict, there are two major concerns you have to take into account: achieving your personal goals and keeping a good relationship with the other person. 17) How important your personal goals are and how important the relationship is to you affect how you act in a conflict. Given these two concerns, five styles of managing conflicts can be identified.

One, the turtle. Turtles withdraw into their shells to avoid conflicts. They give up their personal goals and relationships. They believe it is easier to withdraw from a conflict than to face it.

Two, the shark. Sharks try to overpower opponents by forcing them to accept their solution to the conflict. They seek to achieve their goals at all costs. Sharks assume that conflicts are settled by one person winning and one person losing. Winning gives sharks a sense of pride and achievement. Losing gives them a sense of weakness, inadequacy and failure.

Three, the teddy bear. Teddy bears want to be accepted and liked by other people. They think that conflict should be avoided in favor of harmony and believe that conflicts cannot be discussed without damaging relationships. They give up their goals to preserve the relationship.

Four, the fox. Foxes are moderately concerned with their own goals and about their relationships with other people. They give up part of their goals and persuade the other person in a conflict to give up part of his goals. They seek a solution to conflicts where both sides gain something.

18) Five, the owl. Owls view conflicts as problems to be solved. They see conflicts as improving relationships by reducing tension between two people. They try to begin a discussion that identifies the conflict as a problem. By seeking solutions that satisfy both themselves and the other person, owls maintain the relationship. Owls are not satisfied until a solution is found that achieves their own goals and the other person's goals. And they are not satisfied until the tensions and negative feelings have been fully resolved.

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Questions 16 to 18 are based on the recording you have just heard.

16. Why does the speaker say strategies for managing conflicts can always be changed?

A) Because they are learned.

17. What is said to affect the way one acts in a conflict?

C) The importance of one's goals and of the relationship.

18. Of the five styles the speaker discusses, which views conflicts as problems to be solved?

B) The owl.

Questions 19 to 21 are based on the recording you have just heard.

Listen

主题：绘制基因密码，终结灭绝现象

Source: The Telegraph

Title: Genetic code of every animal and plant on Earth to be mapped to end extinction

19) The genetic code of all 1.5 million known species of animals and plants living on Earth will be mapped to help save species from extinction and boost human health. Scientists hope that cracking the genetic code of plants and animals could help uncover new treatments for infectious diseases, slow aging, improve crops in agriculture, and create new bio-materials. In Britain, organizations including the Natural History Museum, the Royal Botanic Gardens at Kew and the Wellcome Sanger Institute have joined forces to sequence Britain's 66,000 species of animals and plants. Dubbed the Darwin Tree of Life Project, it is expected to take 10 years and cost £100 million. Once completed, all the information will be publicly available to researchers. 20) Many scientists believe that Earth has now entered the sixth mass extinction with humans creating a toxic mix of habitat loss, pollution and climate change, which has already led to the loss of at least 77 species of mammals and 140 types of birds since 1500. It is the biggest loss of species since the dinosaurs were wiped out 66 million years ago. Scientists say that sequencing every species will revolutionize the understanding of biology and evolution, bolster efforts to conserve as well as protect and restore biodiversity. Dr Tim Littlewood, Head of Life Sciences Department at the Natural History Museum said: "Whether you are interested in food or disease, the history of how every organism on the planet has adapted to its environment is recorded in its genetic makeup. How you then harness that is dependent on your ability to understand it. We will be using modern methods to get a really good window on the

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present and the past. And of course a window on the past gives you a prospective model on the future.” Sir Jim Smith, Director of Science at Wellcome, said: “21) Try as I might I can’t think of a more exciting more relevant more timely or more internationally inspirational project. Since 1970, humanity has wiped out 60% of animal populations. About 23,000 of 80,000 species surveyed are approaching extinction. We are in the midst of the sixth great extinction events of life on our planet, which not only threatens wildlife species, but also imperils the global food supply. As scientists, we all realise we desperately need to catalogue life on a fragile planet now. I think we’re making history.”

Questions 19 to 21 are based on the recording you have just heard.

19. What do scientists hope to do by cracking the genetic code of plants and animals?

A) Help save species from extinction and boost human health.

20. What do many scientists believe with regard to Earth?

B) It has entered the sixth mass extinction.

21. How does Sir Jim Smith, Director of Science at Wellcome, describe the Darwin Tree of Life Project?

D) It is the most exciting, most relevant, most timely and most internationally inspirational.

Questions 22 to 25 are based on the recording you have just heard.

Listen

主题：谈自我

Source: The Telegraph

Title: “Death of the individual. There is no such thing as self, argues professor Tom Oliver”

John Donne, the English poet, wrote in the 17th century: “No man is an island, entire of itself; every man is a piece of the continent, a part of the main.” 21) Now a British academic has claimed that human individuality is indeed just an illusion, because societies are far more interconnected at a mental, physical and cultural level than people realise. In his new book, *The Self Delusion*, Prof. Tom Oliver, a researcher in the Ecology and Evolution group at the University of Reading, argues there is no such thing as ‘self’ and not even our bodies are truly ‘us’.

Just as Copernicus realised that the Earth is not the center of the universe, Prof. Oliver said society urgently needs a Copernican-like revolution to understand people are not detached beings but rather part of one connected identity.

"A significant milestone in the cultural evolution of human minds was the acceptance that the Earth is not the center of the universe, the so-called Copernican revolution," he writes. 23) "However, we have one more big myth to dispose of: that we exist as independent selves at the center of a subjective universe. You may feel as if you are an independent individual acting autonomously in the world; that you have unchanging inner self that persists throughout your lifetime, acting as a central anchor-point with the world changing around you. This is the illusion I seek to tackle. We are intimately connected to the world around us."

24) Pro. Oliver argues there are around 37 trillion cells in the body, but most have a lifespan of just a few days or weeks, so the material 'us' is constantly changing. In fact, there is no part of your body that has existed for more than 10 years. Since our bodies are essentially made anew every few weeks, the material in them alone is clearly insufficient to explain the persistent thread of an identity. 25) Prof. Oliver claims that individualism is actually bad for society, and only by realising we are part of a bigger entity can we solve pressing environmental and societal problems.

Through selfish over-consumption we are destroying the natural world and using non-renewable resources at an accelerating rate. "We are at a critical crossroads as a species where we must rapidly reform our mindset and behaviour to act in less selfish ways," he said, so let's open our eyes to the hidden connections all around us. Questions 22 to 25 are based on the recording you have just heard.

22. What is indeed just an illusion according to Prof. Tom Oliver?

D) Human individuality.

23. What does Prof. Tom Oliver think of the idea that we exist as independent selves at the center of a subjective universe?

A) It is a delusion to be disposed of.

24. Why does Prof. Tom Oliver claim that the material 'us' is constantly changing?

D) He contends most of our body cells can only live a few days or weeks.

25. How can we solve pressing environmental and societal problems according to Prof. Tom Oliver?

C) By becoming aware that we are part of a bigger world.

Part III

Reading Comprehension

(40 minutes)

Section A

Directions: In this section, there is a passage with ten blanks. You are required to select one word for each blank from a list of choices given in a word bank following the passage. Read the passage through carefully before making your choices. Each choice in the bank is identified by a letter. Please mark the corresponding letter for each item on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre. You may not use any of the words in the bank more than once.

[Key] AIBDC OMLEN

- 26. A) alleviate
- 27. I) loose
- 28. B) clarity
- 29. D) composers
- 30. C) cognitive
- 31. O) wards
- 32. M) significantly
- 33. L) recover
- 34. E) hurt
- 35. N) soothing



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主题：古典音乐对健康的益处

Source: Amanja Reads Too Much

Title: The Health Benefits of Classical Music

(文章为题目改编来源，非原题，仅供回忆参考)

It's quite remarkable how different genres of music can spark unique feelings, emotions, and memories. Studies have shown that music can reduce stress and anxiety before surgeries and we all gravitate toward our own unique life soundtrack. If you're looking to **26-A) alleviate** stress, you might want to give classical music a try.

The sounds of classical music produce a calming effect letting **27-I) loose** pleasure-inducing dopamine, a

neurotransmitter in the brain that helps control attention, learning and emotional responses. It can also turn down the body's stress response, resulting in an overall happier mood. Turns out a pleasant mood can lead to **28-B) clarity** in a person's thinking.

Although there are many great **29-D) composers** of classical music like Bach, Beethoven and Handel, none of these artists' music seem to have the same health effects as Mozart's does. According to researchers, listening to Mozart can increase brain wave activity and improve **30-C) cognitive** function. Another study found that the distinctive features of Mozart's music trigger parts of the brain that are responsible for high-level mental functions. Even maternity **31-O) wards** use Mozart to help newborn babies adapt to life outside of the womb.

It has been found that listening to classical music **31-M) significantly** reduces a person's blood pressure. Researchers believe that the calming sounds of classical music may help your heart **33-L) recover** from stress. Classical music can also be a great tool to help people who have trouble sleeping. One study found that students who had trouble sleeping slept better while they were listening to classical music.

Whether classic music is something that you listen to on a regular basis or not at all – it wouldn't **34-E) hurt** to take time out of your day to listen to music that you find **35-N) soothing**. You will be surprised at how good it makes you feel and the potentially **positive change in your health**.

A) alleviate	F)	K)
B) clarity	G)	L) recover
C) cognitive	H)	M) significantly
D) composers	I) loose	N) soothing
E) hurt	J)	O) wards

Section B

Directions: In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the questions by marking the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2**.

[Key] CHBKI DNJEO

主题：拥有自己的树

Source: Today I Found Out

Title: The Curious Case of the Tree That Owns Itself

（文章为题目改编来源，非原题，仅供回忆参考）

The Curious Case of the Tree That Owns Itself

- [A] In the city of Athens, Georgia there exists a rather curious local landmark- a large white oak that is almost universally stated to own itself. Because of this, it is considered one of the more famous trees in the world. So how did this tree come to own itself and the land around it, and does the government agree with the general public's sentiment that it legally does? First the back story- sometime in the 19th century a Georgian called Colonel William Jackson, born all the way back in 1786, reportedly took a liking to said tree and endeavored to protect it from any and all danger. As to why he loved it so, the earliest documented account of this story is an anonymously written front page article in the Athens Weekly Banner published on August 12, 1890. It states,
- [B] Col. Jackson had watched the tree grow from his childhood, and grew to love it almost as he would a human. 38-B) Its luxuriant foliage, and sturdy limbs had often protected him from the heavy rains, and out of its highest branches he had many a time gotten the eggs of the feathered songsters. He watched [its] growth, and when on reaching a ripe old age he saw the tree standing in [its] magnificent proportions, he was pained to think that after his death it would fall into the hands of those who might destroy it.
- [C] 36-C) Towards this end, Jackson deeded ownership of the tree and a little land around it to the tree itself. The news article states that the deed read, "I, H. W. Jackson, of the county of Clarke, of the one part, and the oak tree of the county of Clarke, of the other part: Witnessed, That the said W. H. Jackson for and in consideration of the great affection which he bears said tree, and his great desire to see it protected has conveyed, and by these presents do convey unto the said oak tree entire possession of itself and of all land within eight feet of it on all sides."
- [D] In time, the tree came to be something of a tourist attraction, known as The Tree That Owns Itself. However,

in the early 20th century, the tree started showing signs of its slow demise, with little that could be done about it. Father time comes for us all eventually, even our often long lived, tall and leafy fellow custodians of Earth. 41-D) Finally, on October 9, 1942, the over 30 meter tall and 200-400 year old tree fell, rumor has it as a result of a severe windstorm and/or via having previously died and its roots rotted.

[E] About four years later, members of the Junior Ladies Garden Club (who'd tended to the tree before its unfortunate demise) tracked down a small tree grown from an acorn taken from the original tree. And so it was that on October 9, 1946, under the direction of Professor Roy Bowden of the College of Agriculture at the University, this little tree was transplanted to the location of its forebear. 44-E) A couple months later, an official ceremony was held featuring none other than the Mayor of Athens, Robert L McWhorter, to commemorate the occasion.

[F] This new tree became known as The Son of the Tree That Owns Itself and it was assumed that, as the original Tree's heir, it naturally inherited the land it stood on. Of course, there are many dozens of other trees known to exist descending from the original, as people taking an acorn from it to grow elsewhere was a thing. That said, to date, none of the original tree's other children have petitioned the courts for their share of the land, so it seems all good.

[G] In any event, The Son of the Tree That Owns Itself still stands today, though is often referred to as simply The Tree That Own Itself- we can only presume because you don't want to go assuming the tree's gender.... This all brings us around to whether Jackson ever actually deeded the tree to itself in the first place and, either way, if such a deed is legally binding.

[H] Well, to begin with, it turns out Jackson only spent about three years of his life in Athens, starting at the age of 43 from 1829 to 1832, sort of nixing the idea that he loved the tree from spending time under it as a child and watching it grow, and then worrying about what would happen to it after he died. 37-H) Further, an extensive search of land ownership records in Athens does not seem to indicate Jackson ever owned the land the tree sits on.

[I] He did live on a lot of land directly next to it for those three years, but whether he owned that land or not isn't clear. Whatever the case, in 1832 a four acre parcel, which included the land the tree was on and the neighboring land Jackson lived on, among others, was sold to University professor Malthus A Ward. 40-I) In

the transaction, Ward was required to pay Jackson a sum of \$1,200 (about \$31,000 today), either for the property itself or simply in compensation for improvements Jackson had made on the lot, presumed to be the house Jackson built on it.

[J] In the end, whether he ever owned the neighboring lot or was simply allowed to use it while he allegedly worked at the University, he definitely never owned the lot the tree grew on, which is the most important bit for the topic at hand. After Professor Ward purchased the land, Jackson and his family purchased a 655 acre parcel a few miles away and moved there. 43-J) Ten years later, in 1844, Jackson seems to have come into financial difficulties and had his little plantation seized by the Clarke County Sheriff's office and auctioned off to settle the mortgage. Thus, had he owned some land in Athens itself, including the land the tree sat on, presumably he would have sold it to raise funds or otherwise had it taken as well.

[K] 39-K) And whatever the case there, Jackson would have known property taxes needed paid on the deeded land for the tree to be truly secure in its future. Yet no account or record indicates any trust or the like was setup to facilitate this. (And if you're wondering, yes, we double checked and property taxes were a thing in Georgia at the time.)

[L] On top of all this- shocker- there is no hard evidence such a deed ever existed, despite the fact that deed records in Athens go back many decades before Jackson's death in 1876 and that it was supposed to have existed in 1890 in the archives according to the original anonymous news reporter who claims to have seen it.

[M] As you might imagine from all of this, few give credence to this side of the story. So how did all of this come about then?

[N] It is speculated to have been invented by the imagination of said anonymous author at the Athens Weekly Banner in the aforementioned 1890 front page article titled "Deeded to Itself", which by the way contained several elements that are much more easily proved to be false. 42-N) As to why the author would do this, it's speculated perhaps it was a 19th century version of a click-bait thought exercise on whether it would be legal for someone to deed such a non-sentient living thing to itself or not. In fact, the very opening paragraph poses this question, stating: "A tree a property holder. What do you think of that? Is it legal? If so, when the tree dies, to whom does the land belong? If not, whose is it now?"

- [O] Whatever the case, the next known instance of the *Tree That Owned Itself* being mentioned wasn't until 1901 in the Centennial Edition of the that same paper, the Athens Banner. This featured another account very clearly just copying the original article published about a decade before, only slightly reworded. 45-O) The next account was in 1906, again in the Athens Banner, again very clearly copying the original account, only slightly reworded. The 19th century equivalent of re-posts when your audience has forgotten about the original.
- [P] It was this 1906 re-post that saw the tree's future legendary status secured thanks to one George Foster Peabody, who paid to have a marble marker and granite post put in place commemorating the tree owning itself, as well as for some basic maintenance like extra soil added around it. No word on whether he got the tree's permission first for this clear infringement on its property rights.
- [Q] Fast-forward through today, and the Tree That Owns Itself and its child likewise being the master of its own fate is firmly entrenched.
36. Jackson was said to have transferred his ownership of the oak tree to itself in order to protect it from being destroyed.
37. No proof has been found from an extensive search that Jackson had ever owned the land where the oak tree grew.
38. When it was raining heavily, Jackson often took shelter under a big tree that is said to own itself.
39. There is no evidence that Jackson had made arrangements to pay property taxes for the land on which the oak tree sat.
40. Professor Ward paid Jackson over one thousand dollars when purchasing a piece of land from him.
41. It is said the tree that owned itself fell in a heavy windstorm.
42. The story of the oak tree is suspected to have been invented as a thought exercise.
43. Jackson's little plantation was auctioned off to settle his debt in the mid-19th century.
44. An official ceremony was held to celebrate the transplanting of a small tree to where its ancestor had stood.
45. The story of the *Tree That Owned Itself* appeared in the local paper several times, with slight alterations in wording.

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Section C

Directions: There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2** with a single line through the centre.

Passage One

Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.

[Key] BDADC

主题:

Source:

Title:

It is irrefutable that employees know the difference between right and wrong.

46. What is one of the factors contributing to failure of intervention in face of risky behavior in the workplace?

B) Unfavorable workplace culture.

47. What does the author mean by "diffusion of responsibility" (Line 4, Para.3)?

D) The more people are around, the less chance someone will stop forward to intervene.

48. What happens when unsafe behavior at the workplace is not addressed by the leaders?

A) No one will intervene when they see similar behaviors.

49. What is the ultimate reason workers won't act when they see unsafe operations?

D) Fear of having to do more work.

50. What is critical to ensuring workplace safety?

C) Supervisors create a safety environment for timely intervention.

Passage Two

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.

[Key] DCABA

主题: 核能利用

Source: CNET

Title: Nuclear power is clean and safe. Why aren't we using more of it?

The term "environmentalist" is often used as a catch-all, but it can mean different things. It used to refer to people trying to protect wildlife and natural ecosystems. In the 21st century, the term has evolved to encapsulate the need to combat human-made climate change.

51) The distinction between these two strands of environmentalism is the cause of a rift within the scientific community about nuclear energy.

On one side are purists who believe nuclear power isn't worth the risk and the exclusive solution to the climate crisis is renewable energy. 52) The opposing side agrees that renewables are crucial, but says society needs a baseload of power to provide electricity when the sun isn't shining and the wind isn't blowing. Nuclear energy, being far cleaner than oil, gas and coal, is a natural option, especially where hydroelectric capacity is limited.

"It's true that nuclear power can have localized negative impacts," said Leon Clarke, research director at the Center for Global Sustainability, "but it isn't going to melt your glaciers."

Clarke, who helped author reports for the UN's Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change, isn't an uncritical supporter of nuclear energy, but says it's a valuable option to have if we're serious about reaching carbon neutrality.

"Core to all of this is the degree to which you think we can actually meet climate goals with 100% renewables," he said. "If you don't believe we can do it, and you care about the climate, you are forced to think about something like nuclear."

53) The achievability of universal 100% renewability is similarly contentious. Cities such as Burlington, Vermont, have been "100% renewable" for years. But these cities often have small populations, occasionally still rely on fossil fuel energy and have significant renewable resources at their immediate disposal. Meanwhile, countries that manage to run off renewables typically do so thanks to extraordinary hydroelectric capabilities.

"Norway, Iceland, New Zealand, countries like these all have a naturally high supply for hydroelectricity, so I'm not promoting nuclear there," says Dawson, the campaigner from Nuclear New York. "If [renewables] work, and they provide first-world quality of life, great! But most countries are not able to do that."

54) Germany stands as the best case study for a large, industrialized country pushing into green energy.

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Chancellor Angela Merkel in 2011 announced Energiewende, an energy transition that would phase out nuclear and coal while phasing in renewables. Wind and solar power generation are both up over 400% since 2010, and renewables provided 46% of the country's electricity in 2019.

55) But progress has halted in recent years. The instability of renewables doesn't just mean energy is often not produced at night, but also that solar and wind can overwhelm the grid during the day, forcing utilities to pay customers to use their electricity. Lagging grid infrastructure struggles to transport this overabundance of green energy from Germany's north to its industrial south, meaning many factories still run on coal and gas. The political limit has also been reached in some places, with citizens meeting the construction of new wind turbines with vociferous protests.

The result is that Germany's greenhouse gas emissions have fallen by around 11.5% since 2010 -- slower than the EU average of 13.5%.

51. What accounts for the divide within the scientific community about nuclear energy?

D) Adherence to different interpretations of environmentalism.

52. What is the solution to energy shortage proposed by purists' opponents?

C) Opting for nuclear energy when necessary.

53. What point does the author want to make with cities like Burlington as an example?

A) It is controversial whether the goal of the whole world's exclusive dependence on renewables is attainable.

54. What do we learn about Germany regarding renewable energy?

B) It represents a good example of a major industrialized country promoting green energy.

55. What may be one of the reasons for Germany's progress having halted in recent years?

A) Its grid infrastructure's capacity has fallen behind its development of green energy.

Part IV

Translation

(30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on **Answer Sheet 2**.

扇子自古以来就深受中国人喜爱，但现在已不只是消暑纳凉的工具，而更多地作为艺术品供人欣赏。

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许多扇子造型优美、做工精良，并绘有山水、花鸟、人物等精美图案，具有很高的艺术价值。中国许多著名画家和书法家喜欢在扇子上作诗绘画，展示其艺术品味。扇子常作为礼物赠予他人，表达美好的祝福和真挚的情感。如今，扇子的实用功能已大为减弱，但作为一种文化符号和艺术形式，扇子仍然在中国传统文化中扮演着重要角色。

【参考译文】

Since ancient times, fans have been beloved by the Chinese people, but now they are not just tools for cooling off and seeking relief from the heat, but are more often appreciated as works of art. Many fans are beautifully designed and crafted, adorned with exquisite patterns of landscapes, flowers and birds, figures, and more, possessing high artistic value. Many famous Chinese painters and calligraphers enjoy creating poems and paintings on fans, showcasing their artistic taste [sense]. Fans are often given as gifts to express good wishes and sincere emotions. Today, the practical function of fans has greatly diminished, but as a cultural symbol and art form, fans continue to play an important role in Chinese traditional culture.

(From ChatGPT)